Time-Efficient Training Program

2 full-body sessions + optional micro + rowing HIIT · ~2 h 10 total / week · Tempo everywhere: explosive intent up, controlled ~2 s down · Log every set

Mon	**Session A — Strength** · 45–50 min · 1–2 RIR
Tue	Rest
Wed	**Micro session** · ~15 min · protect it while building pull-ups
Thu	Rest
Fri	**Session B — Hypertrophy** · 45–50 min · 0–1 RIR
Sat	Rest / walk
Sun	**Rowing HIIT** · 20–25 min (keep ~48 h before Session A)

Days can shift freely — pattern is workout / rest / workout / rest / workout; never put the two full sessions back-to-back.

Session A — Strength (~45–50 min)

Warm-up ~6 min: joint circles + ramp sets (5 easy pull-ups, 6–8 easy dips; then 3 + 3 harder). Pairs: alternate the two exercises, rest 90 s after each set. Set up all equipment before starting.

Exercise	Sets × reps	RIR	Notes / progression
Pair 1 — 3 rounds (pull-up adjusted to current 5-rep max)			
Pull-up (bodyweight)	4 × 3	1–2	Add 1 rep to one set weekly → 4×5 → shift 3×6–8 → own 3×8 → add 2.5 kg, drop to 5s
Weighted dip	3 × 5–8	1–2	Upper arm ~parallel, slight lean. 8-8-8 → +2.5 kg. No bars: ring / elevated archer push-ups
Pair 2 — 3 rounds			
Weighted Bulgarian split squat	3 × 6–8 /leg	1–2	Weaker leg first, match reps. Both legs 8s on all sets → +2.5 kg
Feet-elevated / weighted row	3 × 8–10	1	Body rigid, full scapular squeeze. Progress: feet higher, add load, flatter angle
Finisher			
Ab-wheel rollout (from knees)	2–3 × 8–12	0–1	Pelvis tucked, ribs down — no low-back sag. Progress range out slowly; wall as depth stop

Session B — Hypertrophy (~45–50 min)

Warm-up ~5 min: joint prep + one easy set of pull-ups and push-ups. Pairs: alternate, rest 60–90 s. Chase reps, not load.

Exercise	Sets × reps	RIR	Notes / progression
Pair 1 — 3 rounds			
Assisted pull-up (band / foot on chair)	3 × 8–12	0–1	Pick assistance so 8–12 is truly hard. Alt.: harder row + 3 slow negatives (4–5 s down)
Archer / deficit push-up	3 × 8–15	0–1	Variation must approach failure by rep 8–15. Progress: deeper deficit, wider archer, feet up
Pair 2 — 3 rounds			
Pistol progression / weighted step-up	3 × 8–12 /leg	0–1	Box pistol → assisted → full → weighted. Knees complain: high step-ups with backpack
Row, easier angle	3 × 10–15	0–1	1-s squeeze at top each rep
Pair 3 — 2–3 rounds, rest 60 s			
Pike push-up	2–3 × 8–12	0–1	Hips high, head to floor between hands. Progress: elevate feet
Hanging leg raise	2–3 × 8–15	0–1	No swing, slow lowering. Bent knee → straight to horizontal → toes-to-bar
Optional finisher (+3 min)			
Rest-pause set: rows or pike push-ups	1 set	0	To ~0 RIR → rest 15–20 s → rep out → rest 15–20 s → rep out. Skip when short on time/energy

Micro session (~15 min) — grease-the-groove for pull-ups

One easy warm-up set of each, then alternate with 60–90 s rest. At home, between work blocks. While pull-up max is low, this likely drives pull-up progress more than the main sessions — protect it for 8–12 weeks.

Exercise	Sets × reps	RIR	Notes / progression
Pull-up (bodyweight, easy)	4–5 × 2	2–3	Genuinely easy, never grinding — frequent crisp practice is the point
Push-up variation	2 × 8–15	0–1	One notch easier than Session B variation

Rowing HIIT (20–25 min) — Sunday

Legs → hips → arms on every stroke; low back neutral. Keep ~48 h before Session A. If Monday pull-ups dip: move to Saturday or start Session A with dips.

Exercise	Sets × reps	RIR	Notes / progression
Main: 4 × 4	4 × 3 min hard	—	5 min easy warm-up; 2 min easy row between intervals; short cool-down. Hard = just sustainable for 3 min
Tired week: 8 × 1	8 × 1 min hard	—	1 min easy between; same envelope, easier to start
Every 3rd–4th week	20 min steady	—	Conversational pace — intensity deload

Rules

Effort	RIR = reps left in the tank when you stop. Strength sets 1–2 RIR, hypertrophy sets 0–1 RIR. Occasionally take a final set to true failure to recalibrate — most people overestimate RIR.
Double progression	Hit the top of the rep range on all sets with good form → add 2.5 kg or move to a harder variation, drop back to the bottom of the range.
Rep standard	A rep counts only at full range with controlled tempo. Form breaks = set over, regardless of RIR target.
Bad-day protocol	Poor sleep / high stress: do the session anyway at ~3 RIR, don't chase progression. A submaximal session beats a skipped one.
Deload	Only on a stall (2 sessions no progress on a lift, recovery normal) or feeling run-down: 1 week at 1–2 sets per exercise, ~3–4 RIR, same load. Expect roughly every 8–12 weeks.
Stall on one lift 3–4 wks	Add a set to that pattern, or grow the micro session for it.
Sessions creep past 50 min	Tighten superset transitions or drop the finisher — never the primary strength work.

Pull-up roadmap (current max: ~5 bodyweight)

Session A 4×3 (+1 rep/week) → 4×5 → 3×6–8 → solid 3×8 → add 2.5 kg, restart at 3×5 → weighted 3×5–8 as written. Session B stays assisted (or rows + negatives) until ~12 clean bodyweight reps. Rows carry most pulling hypertrophy volume meanwhile — make them genuinely hard. Typical timeline for an intermediate: 2–4 months to 3×8; slower if body weight is higher.